



Presented by The High End

CARDBOARD PLAYHOUSE

Walk-In House with an Arched Doorway, Peaked Roof & Two Framed Windows

A peaked-roof cardboard house with an arched doorway they walk straight through.

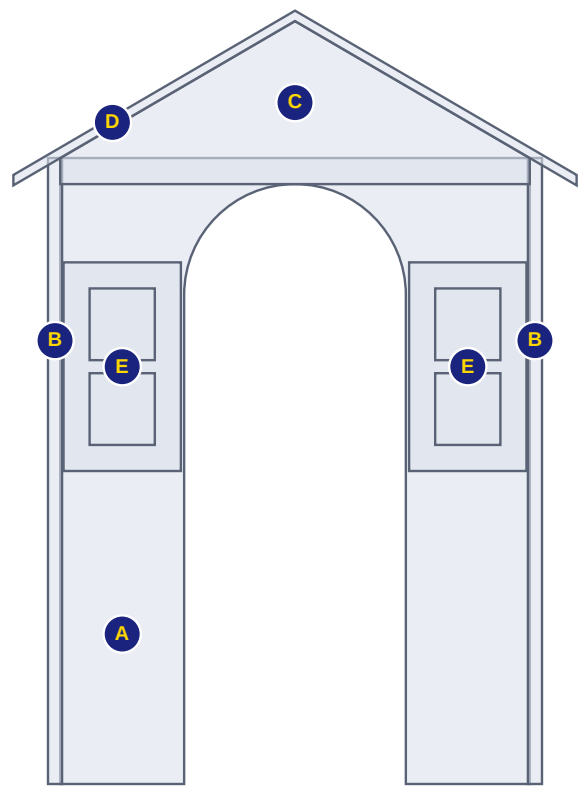
AGES 3–8	BOXES 4 Large Appliance Boxes	TIME 3–4 Hours	DIFF Intermediate **	PIECES 5 pcs
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CARDBOARD NEEDED:
4 Large Appliance Boxes (sides at least 36" × 48" (91 × 122 cm))
FINISHED SIZE:
43" wide × 40" deep at the roof, 58.5" tall (109 × 102 × 149 cm); walls 36" square; door 17" × 46"

MISSION GOAL:
Build the playhouse in the cover photo: four 48" walls, a peaked roof that hangs past the walls, an arched doorway 17" × 46" a child walks through, two framed two-pane windows on the front, and a painted flower pot under each.

HOW IT ALL GOES TOGETHER — CARDBOARD PLAYHOUSE

The finished build, front view, with every part in the place the steps put it and the letter from its own cut-template page. Parts are drawn at their real size relative to each other, so if a letter is on this picture there is a page for it in this file. Pieces that roll into a tube are shown rolled, not laid flat.



EVERY PART IN THIS BUILD

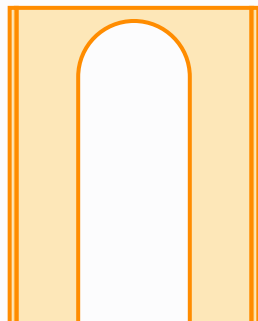
A	FRONT WALL 36" × 48" (91 × 122 cm)	CUT ×1	B	PLAIN WALL 36" × 48" (91 × 122 cm)	CUT ×3
C	GABLE END 36" × 12.5" (91 × 32 cm)	CUT ×2	D	ROOF PANEL 40" × 25" (102 × 64 cm)	CUT ×2
E	WINDOW FRAME 9" × 16" (23 × 41 cm)	CUT ×2			

BUILD SEQUENCE — WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE AFTER EACH STEP

Each picture is the build once that step is finished. The part you just added is the ORANGE one. Grey is what was already there. Work down the page and yours should look like each picture in turn.

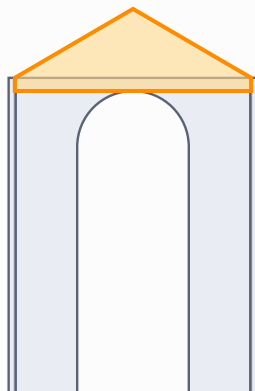
3

STAND UP THE WALLS



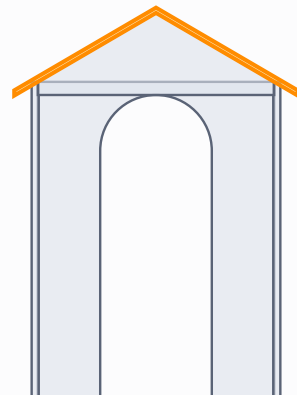
4

ADD THE GABLE ENDS



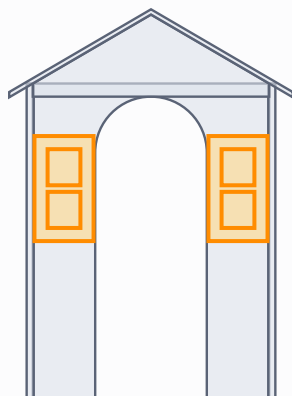
5

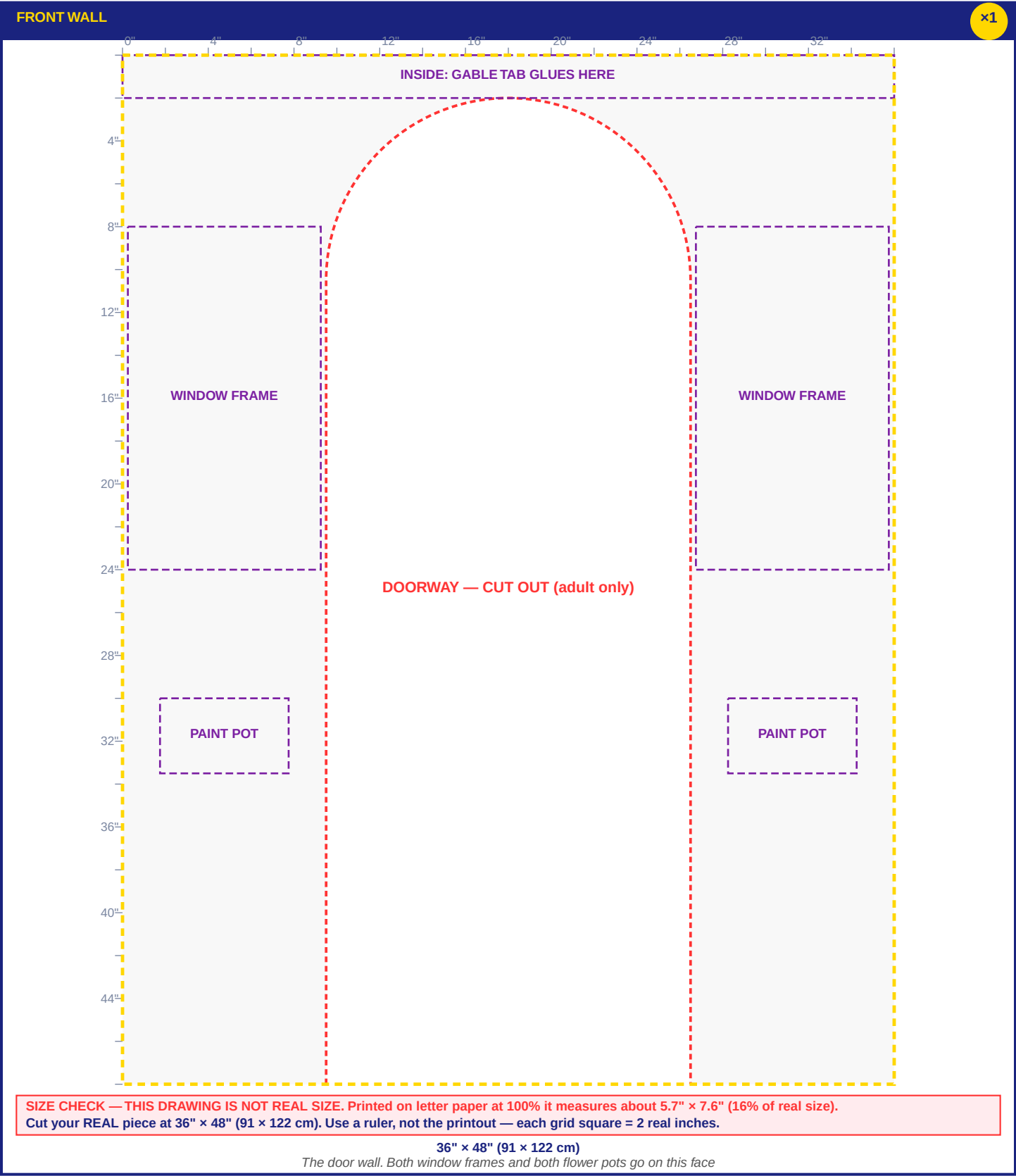
PUT ON THE ROOF



6

ADD THE WINDOW FRAMES





MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

CUT OUT — cut along the red dashes (an orange side is a fold)	GLUE HERE — where another part goes
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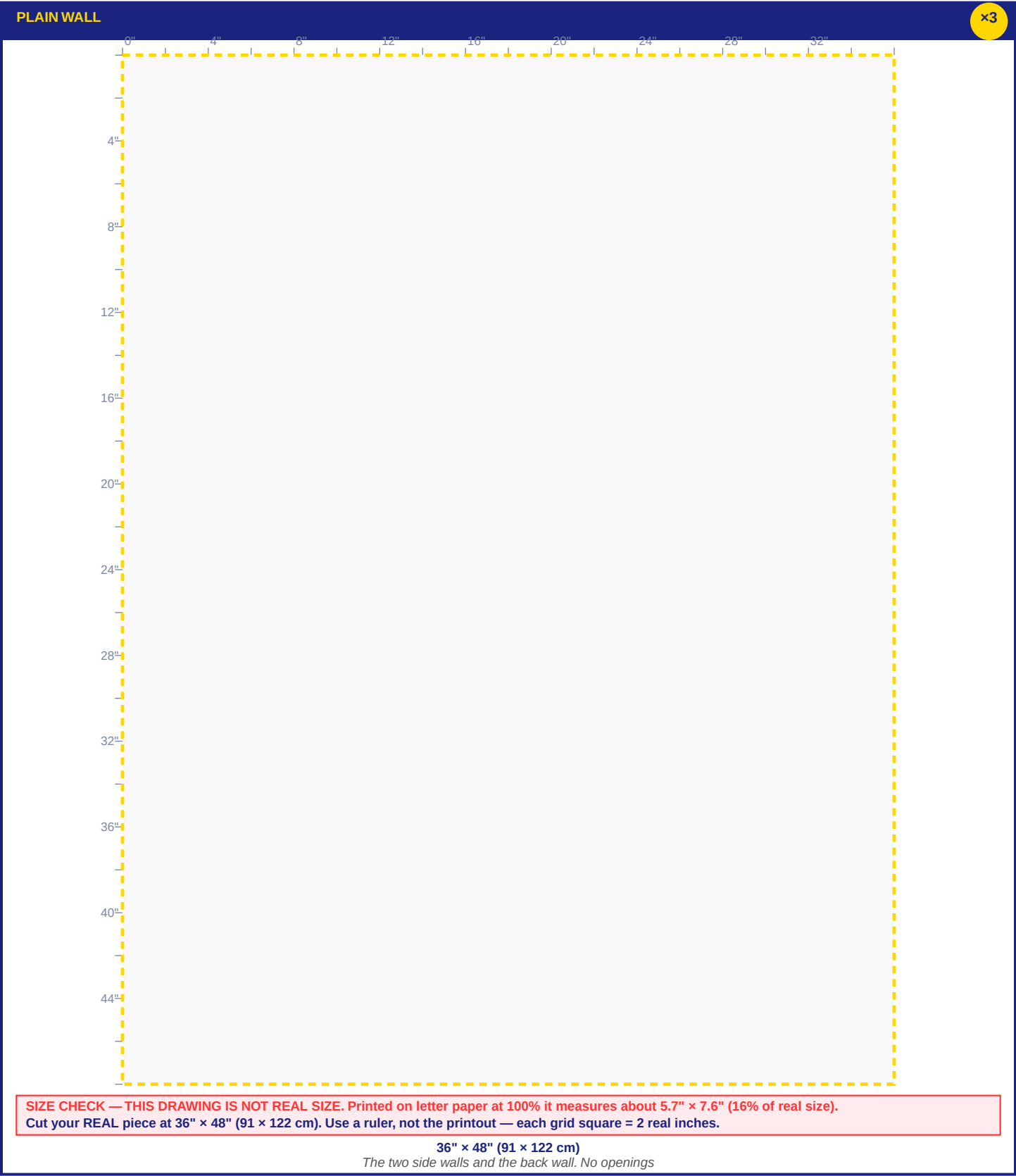
NOTE: The door wall. Both window frames and both flower pots go on this face



PLAIN WALL

36" × 48" (91 × 122 cm) | Cut ×3

CUT
x3



MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

CUT — scissors or box cutter on this line

NOTE: The two side walls and the back wall. No openings



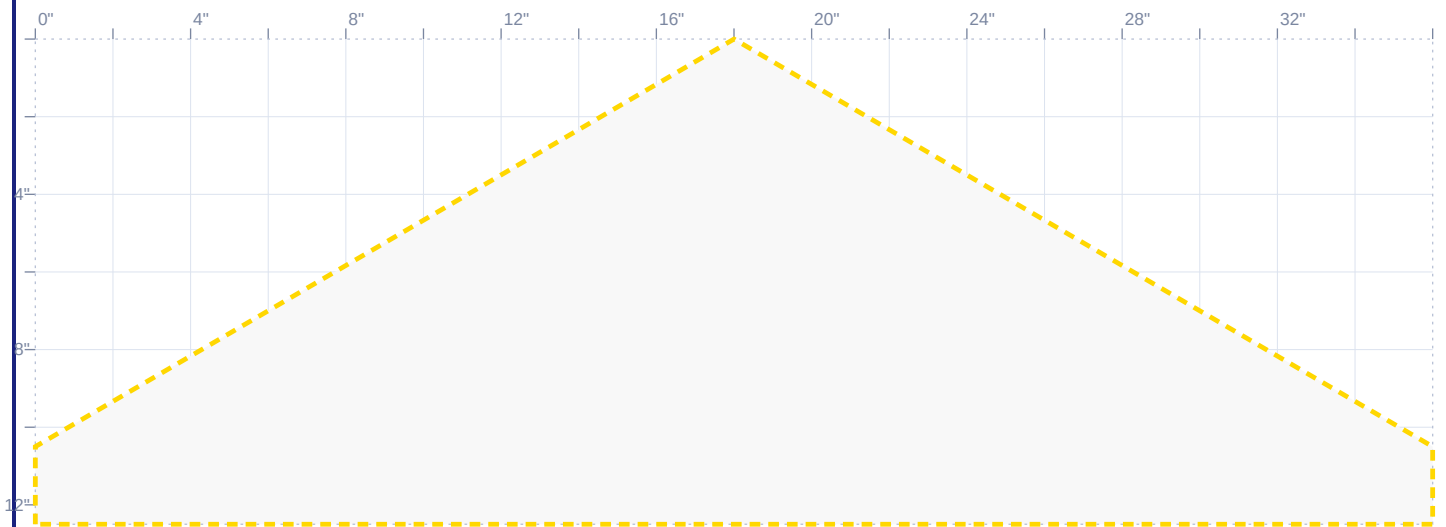
GABLE END

36" × 12.5" (91 × 32 cm) | Cut ×2

CUT
x2

GABLE END

x2



SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" × 2.5" (20% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 36" × 12.5" (91 × 32 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

HOW TO DRAW THIS SHAPE ON YOUR CARDBOARD:

Draw a line 2" up from the bottom edge: that strip is the glue tab. Mark the centre of the top edge. Draw straight lines from that mark down to both ends of the tab line. Each sloped edge comes out 20.8" long; the roof rests on it.

Cut along the GOLD dashed outline. The faint grey box is the flat piece of cardboard it comes from; the grid squares are 2".

36" × 12.5" (91 × 32 cm)

Gable — a glue tab along the bottom, a low triangle standing on it

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GOLD OUTLINE — this is the shape you cut. It is NOT a rectangle.

NOTE: One for the front, one for the back. The 2" tab glues behind the top of the wall



ROOF PANEL

40" × 25" (102 × 64 cm) | Cut ×2

CUT
x2

ROOF PANEL

x2

0"

4"

8"

12"

16"

20"

24"

28"

32"

36"

RIDGE EDGE — tapes to the other roof panel

4"

8"

12"

16"

20"

24"

SIDE WALL TOP RESTS HERE

SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 7.3" × 4.5" (18% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 40" × 25" (102 × 64 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

40" × 25" (102 × 64 cm)
One each side. The 40" edges run front to back; the top edge is the ridge

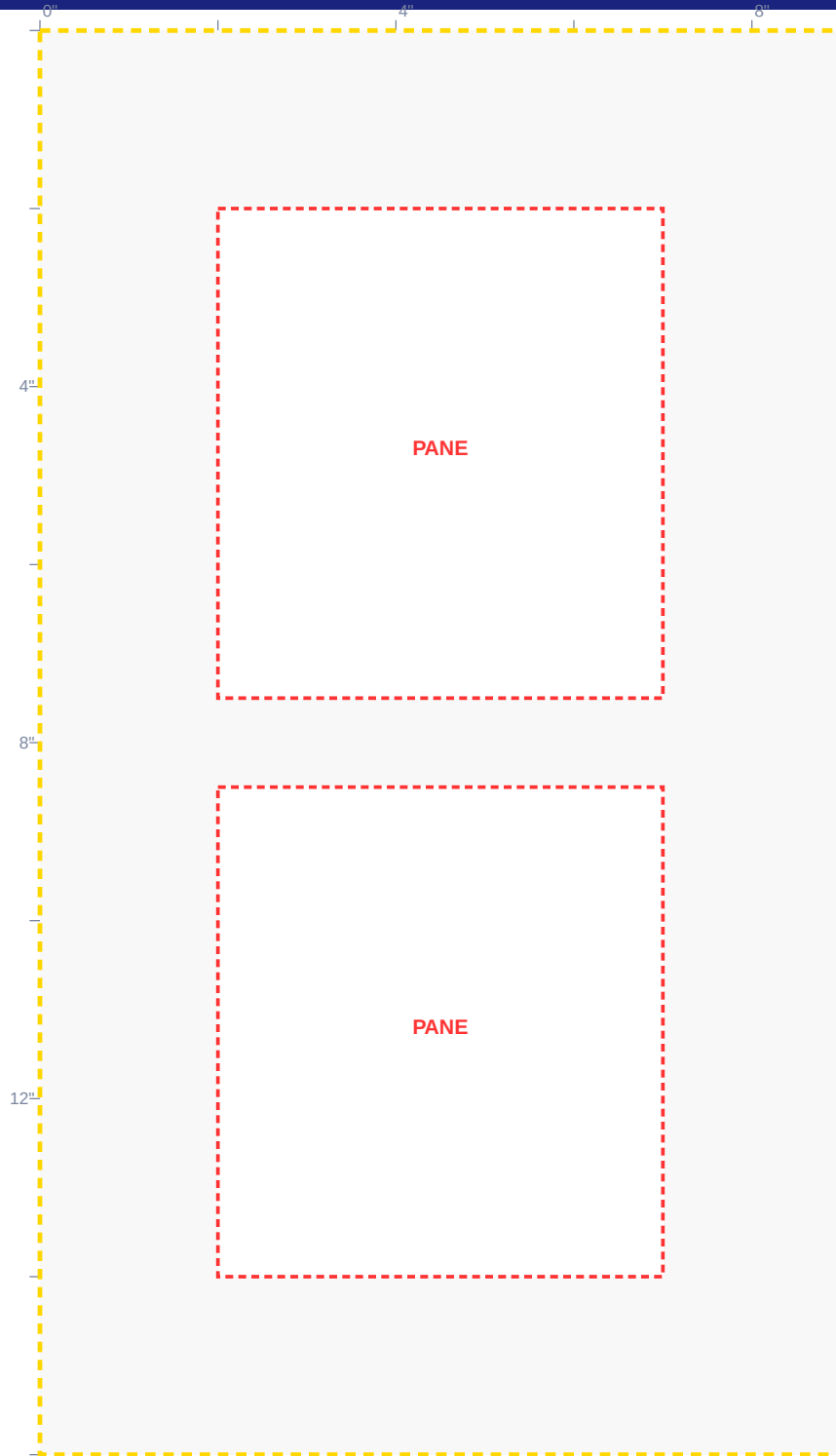
MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

GLUE HERE — where another part goes

NOTE: One each side. The 40" edges run front to back; the top edge is the ridge

WINDOW FRAME

x2



SIZE CHECK — THIS DRAWING IS NOT REAL SIZE. Printed on letter paper at 100% it measures about 4.3" × 7.6" (48% of real size).
Cut your REAL piece at 9" × 16" (23 × 41 cm). Use a ruler, not the printout — each grid square = 2 real inches.

9" × 16" (23 × 41 cm)

Glued onto the front wall, one each side of the doorway

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

CUT OUT — cut along the red dashes (an orange side is a fold)

NOTE: Glued onto the front wall, one each side of the doorway

WHAT YOU NEED — CARDBOARD PLAYHOUSE

CARDBOARD PIECES — 5 TOTAL (4 Large Appliance Boxes (sides at least 36" × 48" (91 × 122 cm)))

×1

Front Wall
36" × 48"

The door wall. Both window frames and both flower pots go on this face

×3

Plain Wall
36" × 48"

The two side walls and the back wall. No openings

×2

Gable End
36" × 12.5"

One for the front, one for the back. The 2" tab glues behind the top of the wall

×2

Roof Panel
40" × 25"

One each side. The 40" edges run front to back; the top edge is the ridge

×2

Window Frame
9" × 16"

Glued onto the front wall, one each side of the doorway

TOOLS & SUPPLIES

+ 4 large appliance boxes (flattened)

+ Box cutter — ADULT USE ONLY

+ Packing tape (3+ rolls)

+ Strong glue: hot glue (adult) or PVA craft glue

+ Long ruler or yardstick + pencil

+ Paint: terracotta brown, dark brown, green, red, yellow, blue

+ Small paintbrush

FUN FACT!

Builders call the triangle under a peaked roof a gable. Your playhouse has two: one over the front door and one at the back, and the roof rests on both.

CHALLENGE!

Housewarming party! Once built, set a table inside, invite stuffed animals, have a snack. What's the most people you can fit?

1

STEP 1: MARK OUT THE PIECES

Flatten the boxes. Mark out template A once and template B 3 times, each on its own 36" × 48" (91 × 122 cm) face, with the cardboard ridges running UP the 48" (122 cm) side so the walls stand stiff. Mark out C twice, D twice with the ridges running along the 40" (102 cm) edge, and E twice. Every size is on the template pages.

2

STEP 2: CUT THE DOORWAY AND PANES

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Cut the doorway out of A on the red dashes: 17" (43 cm) wide and 46" (117 cm) tall with a round top, open at the bottom so there is nothing to trip over. Leave the 2" (5 cm) strip above it. Cut both C pieces on their gold outlines. Cut the 2 panes out of each E: 5" × 5.5" (13 × 14 cm) each, with a 1" (3 cm) bar between them.

SAFETY: Adult cuts. Tape over the doorway edge so it is smooth.

3

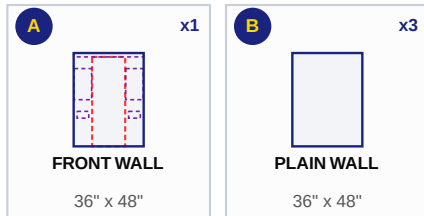
STEP 3: STAND UP THE WALLS

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Stand the Front Wall and the 3 Plain Walls (two sides and the back) up into a 36" (91 cm) square, edges butted together at the corners. Tape every corner from the floor to the top, 3 layers inside and outside. Measure both diagonals across the floor and make them equal so the house is square.

SAFETY: Two people: one holds the walls while the other tapes.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

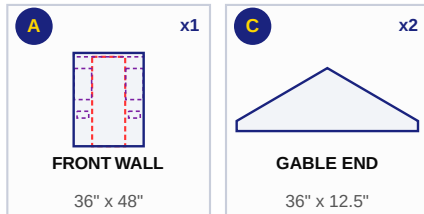


4

STEP 4: ADD THE GABLE ENDS

Glue the 2" (5 cm) tab of one Gable End behind the top of the Front Wall, on the inside, so the low triangle stands up above the wall with its point in the middle, 10.5" (27 cm) above the wall top. Glue the second Gable End the same way on the back wall. Tape along both joins on the inside.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



5

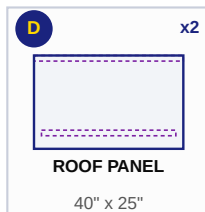
STEP 5: PUT ON THE ROOF

! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

Lay one Roof Panel on each side, ridge edges meeting over the two gable points and the 40" (102 cm) edges running front to back, so 2" (5 cm) hangs past each gable and about 4" (10 cm) past each side wall, like the cover photo. Tape the ridge seam on the outside along its full length. From inside, tape the roof to both gable edges and along the tops of the side walls.

SAFETY: Two people: one holds the roof panels, one tapes.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

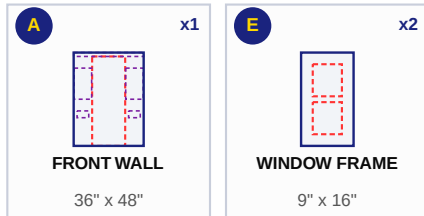


6

STEP 6: ADD THE WINDOW FRAMES

Glue a Window Frame onto the Front Wall on each side of the doorway, in the purple boxes on template A: 8" (20 cm) down from the top of the wall and level with its outer edge. The panes show plain cardboard behind them, like the photo. Optional extra (not in the photo): an adult can cut the wall away behind the panes to make see-through windows.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

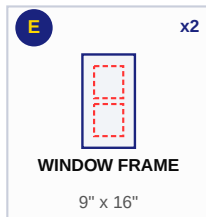


7

STEP 7: PAINT THE FLOWER POTS

Under each window frame, in the PAINT POT boxes on template A, paint a flower pot 6" (15 cm) wide at the top, 5" (13 cm) wide at the bottom and 3.5" (9 cm) tall, its top 6" (15 cm) below the frame. Paint it terracotta brown, then a darker brown rim band 1" (3 cm) deep across the top.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



8

STEP 8: PAINT THE FLOWERS

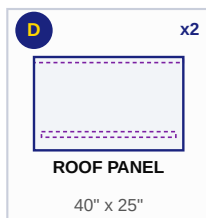
Above each pot paint three flowers on green stems about 3" (8 cm) long: a red one in the middle, standing highest, a yellow one on the left and a blue one on the right. Make each flower 2" (5 cm) across with 5 round petals and a small orange or yellow centre, and add 2 green leaves on the stems. Leave the rest of the house bare cardboard, like the photo.

9

STEP 9: QUALITY CHECK

The child walks through the doorway standing up (children up to about 46" (117 cm) tall; taller ones duck a little). The roof peaks in the middle and hangs past the walls. Two framed windows with 2 panes each sit on the front, one each side of the door, with a painted pot of red, yellow and blue flowers under each. The house stands on its own. Compare to the cover photo. That's the standard.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



QUALITY CHECK!

Does your build match the cover photo? Compare side by side before you call it done.

"Build It. Own It." — Tatum & Kash Cardboard Creations